

Ukrainian Rescue Drivers and Shiftwave

After Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, volunteer drivers carried civilians out of areas under attack, often on very long runs with little rest.

What Shiftwave Did

Within 6 weeks of the full-scale invasion, the Shiftwave team went to Ukraine and donated Shiftwaves to evacuation rescue drivers, including a unit delivered to Kidsave for its rescue drivers. Over six trips, the team has demonstrated and donated the technology at more than 30 sites. Mike North, Ph.D., Shiftwave Co-Founder, Inventor and CEO, filmed Pavlo after a session in April 2022. (Shiftwave, Ukraine Support report)

What the Drivers Reported

Ukrainian evacuation drivers (n=23): anxiety down 80% on average and completely eliminated in 68%; pain down 66% and fully eliminated in 43%. (Shiftwave internal data, Ukraine rescue drivers)

Other groups in the same Shiftwave data: Ukrainian aid workers (n=20): stress down 23%, pain down 80%, pain fully eliminated in 60%. US frontline hospital staff during COVID (n=24): stress down 82%, pain down 37%, pain fully eliminated in 54%.

In Their Words

> "Stress, yes. It's gone. The stress is leaving." Pavlo

> "My head is freeing up. It was clenched, it was tight." Pavlo

> "They're just not getting any sleep, they're totally stressed out." Mike North

> "...relaxation after a tense trip that lasts 20 hours." Kidsave rescue driver

> "Sometimes you need to sit for a bit and let go of all this stress." Kidsave rescue driver

> "...a great chair, on which you can really get quality rest." Kidsave rescue driver

Why It Matters for US Truckers

Long hours, irregular sleep, and stress that builds up behind the wheel are part of every professional driver's job. These drivers faced them at the extreme, on runs of up to 20 hours. What they described is a reset that fit where they were, between runs.

Watch the video: gordonshiftwave.github.io/driver2

Driver quotes were translated from Russian and Ukrainian. Personal experiences, not medical claims. Data provided by Jeffrey Rouse, M.D., Shiftwave Chief Medical Officer.

Full English Transcripts

Timestamps match the combined video.

Pavlo, volunteer evacuation bus driver (filmed April 2022)

[0:03] Mike North: He's been driving day and night all over Ukraine, going right into the front lines and evacuating women and children and orphans. They've evacuated 9,000 kids so far. They're just not getting any sleep, they're totally stressed out, and they're being exposed to trauma themselves. So now they're going to have a Shiftwave there for them to use.

[0:27] Mike North: So Pavlo just did the Shiftwave. He's been driving the buses.

[0:32] Pavlo: Thank you very much.

[0:34] Mike North: How do you feel? Stress?

[0:38] Pavlo (translated from Russian): Stress, yes. It's gone. The stress is leaving. Very good, and my head is freeing up. It was clenched, it was tight. My head is relaxing, it's going out, going out. A lot better, really. Thank you. Super, just super.

[0:56] Pavlo (Russian, then Ukrainian): This will be a big help for our guys. It will be a great help for our guys, who are saving people, who are saving children. So thank you very much, thank you very much, from the bottom of my heart.

[1:10] Mike North: They need some serious on-demand R&R.

Rescue driver, Kidsave, near Vinnytsia, Ukraine (translated from Russian)

[1:19] Driver: I would like to share my impressions of this chair, which helps us a lot after long trips.

[1:27] Driver: It is very nice, really great. When you arrive, you can relax here, setting the mode that is comfortable for you.

[1:36] Driver: There are really great programs in this computer, which let you, so to speak, relax, get some relaxation after a tense trip that lasts 20 hours.

[1:48] Driver: You know, sometimes you need to sit for a bit and let go of all this stress, and this chair helps you deal with this stress very well.

[1:58] Driver: We are grateful for such a great chair, on which you can really get quality rest.

[2:03] Driver: Thank you very much.